

would also be constructed. A Mukhya Mantri Sadak Yojana has been initiated to connect villages left uncovered under PMGSY. The work of connecting all divisional headquarters by four lane roads and districts by two lane roads is also being taken up this year. With private sector participation 2000 km length of district roads would be upgraded and widened in the first phase and 3000 km in the second phase.

Agriculture is the mainstay of state's economy. The state government has paid special attention to augmenting irrigation potential. The five years tenure of the previous government had seen creation of only 1.71 lakh hectare additional irrigation potential against which irrigation potential for 4 lakh hectare has been created at a cost of Rs. 5739 crore in last five years. A budget provision of Rs. 1302 crore has been made in year 2009-10 for irrigation to bring another 90 hectare under irrigation. Moreover, 16 medium projects estimated to cost Rs. 685 crore have been sanctioned. As many as 1254 minor projects have also been sanctioned to create additional irrigation potential for 3.09 lakh hectare. A provision of Rs. 350 crore has been made for Water Sector Re-structuring Project this year.

Power is a major infrastructure component. The state government has made concerted efforts to ensure that consumers get adequate electricity at reasonable rates. The state government has resolved to ensure 24-hour supply to farm sector, general consumers and industry while pursuing power sector reforms by 2011. The Planning Commission has lauded Madhya Pradesh for considerable increase in power generation capacity. As many as 83,590 lakh unit more electricity was supplied last year in comparison to year 2002-03. The increase is 31 percent. Similarly, 7019 mw power was supplied which is an all time record. To improve electricity supply in rural areas 286 feeders have been separated and the work of feeder separation will be completed in next four years. Rs. 1400 crore have been arranged from Asian Development Bank for expansion of distribution system. Funds are also being mobilized from WB for proper maintenance of power plants and renovation of Amarkantak and Satpura thermal power stations.

In view of the most crucial role of agriculture in state's economy and pitiable condition of farming the state government has made efforts to make agriculture a lucrative proposition. For this, steps have been taken to reduce the cost of agriculture and to ensure remunerative returns to farmers of their produce. A sum of Rs. 1232 crore has been set aside to provide subsidy to agricultural power consumers. Subsidy of Rs. 80 crore would be provided to scheduled caste and scheduled farmers on their five horsepower pumps. The period of Krishak Rahat Yojana has been extended to September and a provision of Rs. 178 has been made for this. Last year 4.12 lakh consumers benefited from this. A number of subsidies are being provided to farmers for constructing ponds in their fields, purchasing farm implements and other inputs. It has been decided to provide Rs. 24 thousand subsidies on tube wells to general category farmers as well. All 313 development blocks have

been directly connected to computer by setting up Krishi Vigyan Kendras. State's first agriculture based community radio station has been set up at Sironj. A Kisan Call Centre has been established to provide information about agriculture, horticulture, animal husbandry and fisheries free of cost to the farmers. Under ATMA project Krishak Pathshalas and demonstrations are being organized to impart training to farmers. A State Agriculture Extension and Training Centre has been set up and a new Agriculture University has been established at Gwalior.

Due attention has been paid to increasing investment in industrial sector. As a result most of the big industrial houses have come forward to invest in the state. As per an assessment of the central government, Madhya Pradesh is now notched up from 11th to 6th place in respect of proposed investment in comparison to 2003.

The most important feature of development endeavour of the state government has been that it has paid equal attention to infrastructure and social sector. In today's world education is going to play the most important role in development and India is moving towards being a knowledge based society. Equal attention has been paid to quantitative and qualitative improvement of education. This year 795 new schools and 200 girls hostels are being set up. This year 24 thousand teachers would be recruited. Free textbooks and uniforms are being provided to students. Special attention has been paid to girls education.

Women empowerment has been on the top of state government's agenda. Madhya Pradesh is the first state in the country to provide 50 percent reservation to women in three-tier Panchayatraj and civic bodies. For integrated development of women and children the state government has made a remarkable increase of Rs. 729 crore in the budget of Women and Child Development department. The increase is about 76 percent over last year. Committed efforts are on to improve the nutrition level of children and women. Very soon, 9691 additional anganwadi centers and 9820 mini anganwadi centers would be set up. As many as 150 nutrition rehabilitation centers have been set up for seriously malnourished children.

Madhya Pradesh has received accolades at national level for its Ladali Laxmi Yojana. Under this, about 3 lakh girls have already been registered. A provision of Rs. 276 crore has been made for the scheme in the state.

The budget of Social Justice Department has also been increased by 47 percent. Marriages of about 90 thousand girls of poor families have been sponsored under Mukhya Mantri Kanyadan Yojana. Concrete steps have been taken to improve the lot of labourers of unorganized sector. So far, 17.34 lakh beneficiaries have been registered under Janshri Yojana.

One would, thus, conclude that Madhya Pradesh is all poised to keep pace with the rest of world in every field and the last five years have laid the foundation of a Golden Madhya Pradesh.

